***When empires clash*: modern-day outcomes of historical Greek and Turkish language encounters**

PANEL PROPOSAL

Chair: Petros Karatsareas (*University of Cambridge*)

This panel explores the linguistic fate of speaker communities that experienced intense exchange of Greek and Turkish cultural elements in their history as parts of the Byzantine and Ottoman Empires. The focus is (*a*) on the present-day linguistic situation of currently or formerly multilingual communities that are at present found scattered in the historical territories of the two Empires, and (*b*) on the ways their linguistic varieties embody the effects of both centuries-long cultural osmosis between the majority populations of the two *imperia* and more recent language encounters following such population fluxes as the 1923 Exchange of Populations. The Greek dialects of Pontus and Cappadocia that are nowadays spoken in Greece and Turkey as well as the Turkish dialect(s) of Cyprus fit nicely within that description. Throughout the twentieth century and following the dissolution of the Ottoman sociohistorical conditions that gave rise to their very existence, these varieties have continuously failed to conform to the ideals of ethnic homogeneity and purity within their present-day national boundaries owing either to the high degree of lexical and structural borrowing from or to their genetic affiliation to the language of the *other* (Cappadocian and Pontic Greek as spoken in Greece, Cypriot Turkish; Pontic Greek as spoken in Turkey). As a result, the unique kind of linguistic wealth that these varieties represent, which can be conceived as the living expression of hundreds of years of Eastern Mediterranean and Asia Minor cultural history, is now facing the prospect of extinction. Against this backdrop, the contributors to this panel illustrate how the fascinating past of the surviving Greek-Turkish contact varieties has shaped their shaky present and how it, in its turn, foreshadows their future, which in the case of certain varieties is undoubtedly one of endangerment. The panel is divided into two parts: Part I *Continuity* looks at those varieties that have been spoken continuously in their natural habitat whereas Part II *Change* deals with those varieties whose speakers have had to abandon their historical homelands in their recent past, bringing their language into new, and often not-so-welcoming, environments.

Part I: CONTINUITY

Ottoman linguistic survival in a post-Ottoman context: the case of Romeyka

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Romeyka is a Greek dialect cluster comprising a number of subdialects spoken in north-eastern Turkey, in the area traditionally known as *Pontus* (cf. Mackridge 1987). The Exchange of Populations between Greece and Turkey, as stipulated by the Treaty of Lausanne in 1923, saw all Christians of Asia Minor relocating in Greece and all Muslims of Greece relocating in Turkey. Given that religion was the defining criterion for the selection of the populations to participate in the relocation programme, Romeyka speakers, by virtue of being Muslim, were allowed to stay in their Asia Minor homeland, while for Christian speakers of Pontic Greek, exodus from Pontus was the only option. This is how we can explain the survival of Greek in this remote corner of the world today. Romeyka is becoming severely attrited through contact with Turkish, which is the major language of the community. At present, Romeyka is used in informal contexts only. The more able speakers of Romeyka are women above 60 years of age because only they can qualify as first language acquirers. This applies, to a lesser extent, to men of the same age group. In the population of 40 years old, men can qualify as late first language acquirers whereas for the women of the same age group, although Romeyka is still acquired as first language, there are significant signs of attrition from dominant Turkish. In the child population, the situation is more fragile because girls qualify as late first language acquirers, whilst boys are acquiring Romeyka as an early second language (cf. Sitaridou, forthcoming). Overall, there is Romeyka-Turkish bilingualism and/or diglossia. Against these unfavourable sociolinguistic conditions and despite extensive calquing through contact, Romeyka has survived. Furthermore, against a background of almost total eclipse of the infinitive from the Greek language–a clear marker of conservatism–, Romeyka still shows a robust use of the infinitive. This infinitival survival against all odds gains further importance because it can be unfailingly dated to Hellenistic times rather than Medieval times which still exhibit some residual infinitive usage (cf. Sitaridou, submitted).

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Precarious stability: the case of Cypriot Turkish

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Cypriot Turkish is a variety displaying some rather distinctive syntactic and lexical properties, which are typically attributed to heavy contact with (Cypriot) Greek. Historical and synchronic evidence suggests that bilingualism has always been a prevalent feature of the Turkish Cypriot community, while residual bilingualism or even monolingualism (Cypriot Greek only) is still attested for some subsets of the community (Ioannidou, 2009). The sharp break in the community's bilingual profile was naturally effected post-1974; subsequent dramatic demographic changes, notably forced movement of Turkish Cypriot speaking populations from the southern to the northern part of the island as well as the ongoing influx of settlers from Turkey form the sociolinguistic background that has favored the levelling of geographical subvarieties and the emergence of a Turkish Cypriot *koine* (Theocharous, 2009). This paper examines syntactic features of Cypriot Turkish which can be explained as a result of contact with Cypriot Greek and also looks at features which are subject to leveling as opposed to features which are an integral part of the emergent *koiné*; specifically, the paper examines (*a*) the SVO order, (*b*) the absence of *–mI* in polar questions, (*c*) the differential use of *ki*, *şu* and *hani* (as well as *o şu, o ki, hani şu* and *şu ki*) in complement and relative clauses, (*d*) focus and *wh*-clefts (*e*) the 'common Cypriot subjunctive' (Kappler & Tsiplakou, in press a) and (*f*) Cypriot-specific *mIş* (Demir, 2007; Demir & Johansson, 2006; Gulle, 2011; Kappler, 2008; Kappler & Tsiplakou, in press b). The paper further addresses the intricacies of the sociolinguistic situation and its effects on the differential association of particular variants with overt or covert prestige, which may in turn have differential effects on their stability and/or leveling. It is shown that while some Cypriot-specific variants (termed *köylü* 'peasanty') are associated with low prestige and are hence subject to leveling, others survive or even form the structural basis for Cypriot-specific innovations in the *koiné*. In the face of the still prevalent diglossia between Cypriot and Standard Turkish, the *koiné* emerges as a *prestige* variety, which may well void the prospect of dedialectization.

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Part II: CHANGE

Only the fittest will survive*: metalinguistic awareness as a means of cultural survival among two Cappadocian-speaking communities in northern Greece*

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Following the relocation of its speakers in Greece after the 1923 population exchange, the dialect of the Greek Orthodox communities of Cappadocia, which has been celebrated as a language in which "the body has remained Greek, but the soul has become Turkish" (Dawkins, 1916: 198), was soon considered to have succumbed to the pressures exerted on it by Standard Greek, and by the end of the 20th century it was already declared extinct (Kontossopoulos, 1981: 7; Sasse, 1992: 66). In spite of the scholars' assertions, however, at least some varieties of the dialect continued to be spoken and transmitted natively in a number of relatively homogeneous dialect enclaves in central and northern Greece, resisting assimilation to the country's linguistic majority. In this paper, I examine the factors that favoured the survival of the most robustly spoken Cappadocian variety, *Misiótika*, that originates in the village of *Mistí* (today's *Konaklı*), focusing specifically on the refugee communities of the villages of *Néo Aghionéri* and *Xi-*

rochóri in the vicinity of Thessaloniki. Drawing on the findings of extensive linguistic and ethnographic fieldwork in the area, I show how (*a*) a vivid network of myths surrounding the origin, purpose and reason for the existence of *Misiótika*; (*b*) the negatively constructed identity of the *Misiótika* speakers as Asia Minor refugees and non-Standard Greek speakers within the larger geographical area of Central Macedonia; and, recently, (*c*) the international attention the language has received among the scientific community have played a paramount role in developing and sustaining an unusually high degree of metalinguistic awareness within the communities of the two villages that in its turn has proven to be the key in keeping *Mistí* Cappadocian alive.

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Cultural survival shifts focus: the case of Pontic Greek

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Pontic Greek is a variety of Greek spoken both within and outside Greece. Within Greece it is mainly spoken in Macedonia (especially in Thessaloniki, Kozani, Imathia, Kilkis, Pieria and Drama), Thrace, and to a lesser extent in Attica. Outside Greece it is spoken in north-eastern Turkey and in the Caucasus. It is also spoken by Pontic immigrants in Germany, Belgium, Holland and Sweden. Pontic diaspora is also to be found in the USA and Australia. However, despite (*i*) the numerical robustness of speakers of Pontic (linguistic and cultural) heritage/descent in Greece (Pontic is reportedly the Greek variety with the highest number speakers –above 2 million in Greece alone); and (*ii*) the apparently superior linguistic self-esteem of Pontic speakers, in real terms, the majority of speakers: (*a*) who are simultaneous bilinguals exhibit loss or incomplete acquisition of Pontic Greek under conditions of exposure and use of the majority language namely, Standard Modern Greek (SMG) (cf. Silva-Corvalán, 2003, *inter alios*); in particular, recent work (Tsimpli *et al.*, 2003) suggests that while narrow syntax is impervious to language loss or attrition, syntax-related interfaces like syntax-discourse are not. However, Pontic Greek L1 speakers show considerable attrition manifested at narrow

syntax e.g., proclisis instead of enclisis, excessive clitic-doubling, along with the predicted interface attrition, e.g. no production of discourse-particles. It is argued that in this case bidialectalism with Standard Modern Greek may trigger narrow-syntax-on-related attrition otherwise not predicted; or (*b*) have become L2 speakers of Pontic Greek; or (*c*) have become heritage speakers who use some Pontic Greek lexis pertaining to the semantic fields of food, emotions, etc., and usually denoting cultural or material concepts not present in Standard Modern Greek; or (*d*) have suffered language-shift to Standard Modern Greek. In fact, stages (*a-d*) represent different points in a cline of progressive language loss. While Pontic Greek is often associated with positive attitudes mostly relating to the widely perceived linguistic purity and close-relatedness to Ancient Greek, (*i*) full integration into the educational system as early as the first generation of refugee speakers; (*ii*) counteracting stereotypes regarding Pontic identity; (*iii*) the expected prestige of Standard Modern Greek; (*iv*) complete absence of positive attitudes in public *fora* regarding varieties in general, has led to the current endangered status of Pontic Greek. Consequently, identity making shifts from language to other markers.

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